

India Inc on Health Drive

With lifestyle diseases affecting employee efficiency and attendance, two in every five Indian corporates added wellness programmes in 2009, reports HR consulting firm Mercer: PepsiCo rewarded employees for losing flab, Hewlett-Packard employees got online health profiles, Maruti Suzuki and LG promoted morning workouts, Bharti Airtel sponsored marathons and TCS took up a 'serenity' initiative to improve employee well-being. Way to go!



Cool and composed, sunny and sympathetic—that's your hospital nurse. But new research in the current

Indian Journal of Occupational & Environmental Medicine shows how psychosomatic disorders are striking the sisters. A serious shortfall of manpower and excessive workload results in 60 per cent of nurses complaining of headaches, 47 per cent of backaches, 62 per cent of acidity, 32 per cent of anaemia, and 40 per cent are tired all the time. Forgetfulness, depression and temper tantrums are on the rise, too. Physician heal thyself?

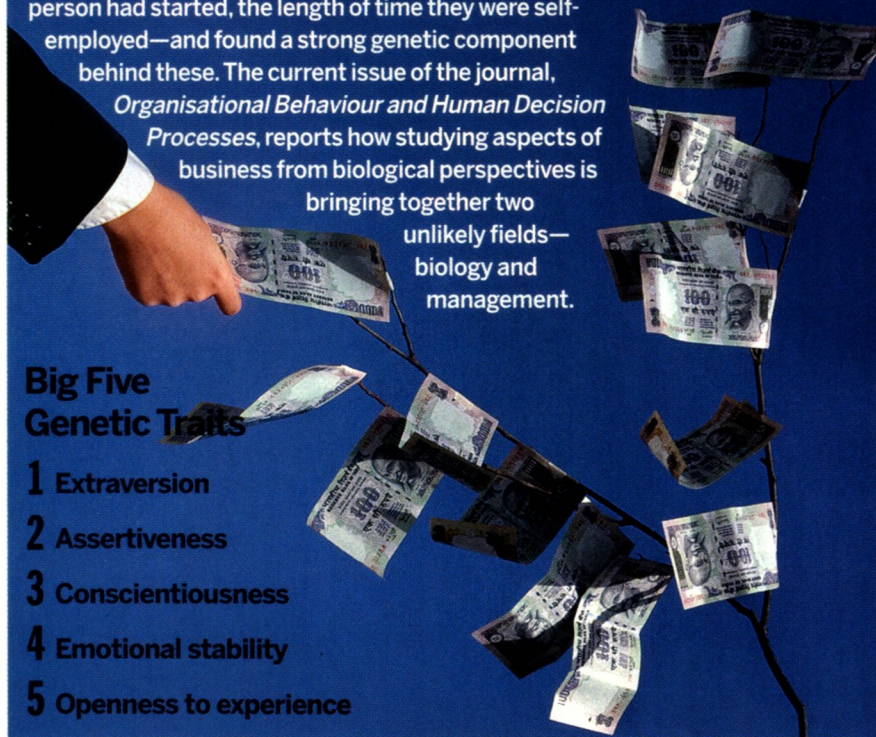
■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**

ARE ENTREPRENEURS BORN OR MADE?

How inheritable is the ability to work hard, take risks, and seize opportunities? According to researchers at the Department of Twin Research and Genetic Epidemiology at King's College, London, 37-48 per cent of the tendency to be an entrepreneur is genetic. The researchers tested a number of entrepreneurship indicators—running or starting a business, number of businesses a person had started, the length of time they were self-employed—and found a strong genetic component behind these. The current issue of the journal, *Organisational Behaviour and Human Decision Processes*, reports how studying aspects of business from biological perspectives is bringing together two unlikely fields—biology and management.

Big Five Genetic Traits

- 1 Extraversion
- 2 Assertiveness
- 3 Conscientiousness
- 4 Emotional stability
- 5 Openness to experience



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India is slated to lose **\$237** billion between 2005 and 2015 due to a drop in productivity, says the WHO. Reason? Coronary problems in the young workforce.

CLEAN AND CLEAR

The swine flu pandemic may have made hand sanitizers trendy, but read the fine print before you spend good money on one. Experts say, sanitizers do kill quite a lot of bacteria and viruses. But here's the catch: they can't take care of dirt. Hence there's no substitute for soap and water. Go for a sanitizer only when you don't have soap and water readily available. But if you really want to use one, opt for a gel that contains at least 60 per cent alcohol.

